Chapter 68

Node Groups, Macros, and Fusion Templates

This chapter reveals how to use groups, macros, and templates in Fusion so working with complex effects becomes more organized, more efficient, and easier.

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Groups

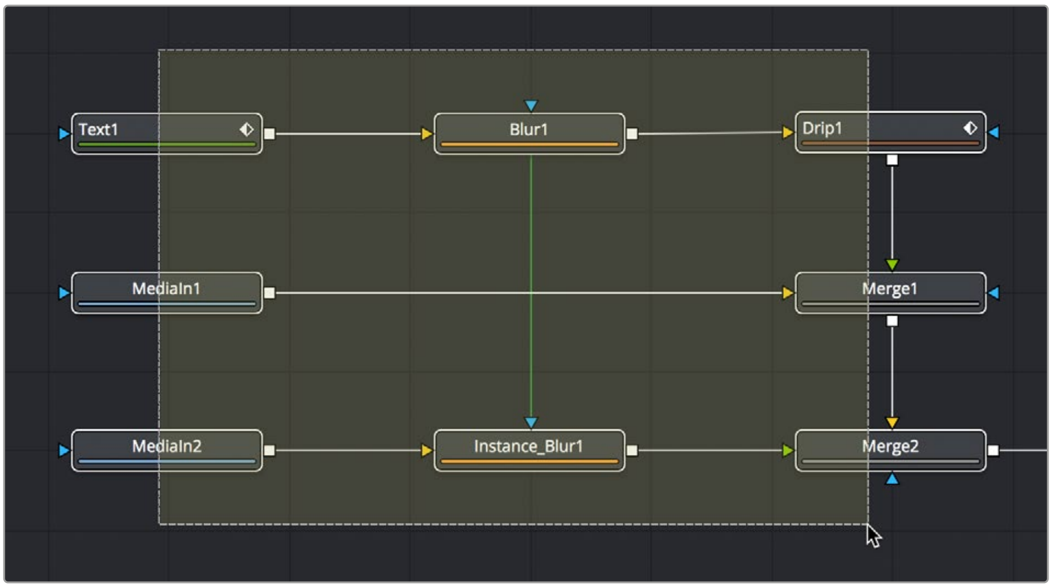
When you work on complex visual effects, node trees can become sprawling and unwieldy, so grouping tools together can help you better organize all the nodes and connections. Groups are containers in your node tree that can hold multiple nodes, similar to the way a folder on your Desktop holds multiple files. There is no limit to the number of nodes that can be contained within a group, and you can even create subgroups within a group.

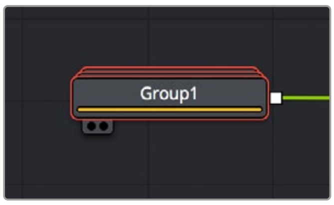
Creating Groups

Creating a group is as simple as selecting the nodes you want to group together and using the Group command.

To create a group:

1. Select the nodes you want grouped together.
2. Right-click one of the selected nodes and choose Group from the contextual menu (Command-G).





Several nodes selected in preparation for making a group (top), and the resulting group (bottom).

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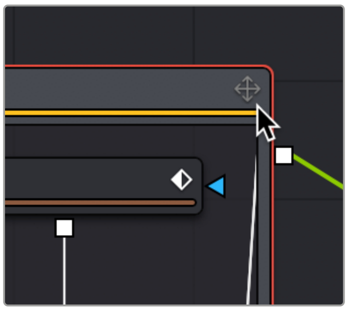
The selected nodes are collapsed into a group, which is displayed as a single node in the Node Editor. The Group node can have inputs and outputs, depending on the connections of the nodes within the group. The Group node only displays inputs for nodes that are already connected to nodes outside the group. Unconnected inputs inside the group will not have an Input knot displayed on the Group node.

Deleting Groups

Deleting a group is no different from deleting any other node in the Node Editor. Select a group and press Delete, Backspace, or Forward-Delete, and the group along with all nodes contained within it are removed from the node tree.

Expanding and Collapsing Groups

A collapsed group is represented by a single "stack" node in the node tree. If you want to modify any of the nodes inside the group, you can open the group by double-clicking it or by selecting the group node and pressing Command-E.



An open group window showing the minimize button.

When you open a group, a floating window shows the nodes within that group. This floating window is its own Node Editor that can be resized, zoomed, and panned independently of the main Node Editor. Within the group window, you can select and adjust any node you want to, and even add, insert, and delete nodes while it is open. When you're ready to collapse the group again, click the minimize button at the top left corner of the floating window, or use the keyboard shortcut (Cmd-E).

Panning and Scaling within Open Group Windows

You can pan and scale an open group window using the same mouse buttons you use to pan and scale the main Node Editor. However, when you're working in an expanded group and simultaneously making changes to the main node tree, you may want to prevent the expanded group from being individually panned or scaled. Turning off the Position button at the right of the group title bar locks the group nodes to the size of the nodes in the rest of the overall node tree. Turning on this Position button lets you size group nodes independently of the rest of the node tree.

Ungrouping Nodes

If you decide you no longer need a particular group, or you simply find it easier to have constant access to all the nodes in the group at once, you can decompose or "ungroup" the group without deleting the nodes within it to eliminate the group but keep the contents in the Node Editor.

To ungroup nodes, do the following:

1. Right-click on the group.
2. Choose Ungroup from the contextual menu. The nodes inside the group are placed back in the main node tree.

Saving and Reusing Groups

One of the best features of groups is that every group and its settings can be saved for later use in other shots or projects. Groups and their settings can be recalled in various ways.

A good example of when you might want to Save and Load a group is in a studio with two or more compositing artists. A lead artist in your studio can set up the master comp and create a group specifically for keying greenscreen. That key group can then be passed to another artist who refines the key, builds the mattes, and cleans up the clips. The setting can then be saved out and loaded back into the master comp. As versions are improved, these settings can be reloaded, updating the master comp.

Methods of saving and reusing groups:

- **To save a group:** Right-click a group and choose Settings > Save As from the contextual menu.
- **To reuse a group:** Drag it from your computer's file browser directly into the Node Editor. This creates a new group node in the node tree with all the same nodes as the group you saved.
- **To load the settings from a saved group to another group with the same nodes:** Right-click a group in the Node Editor and choose Settings > Load from the contextual menu.

In Fusion Studio, you can also save and reuse groups from the Bins window:

- **To save a group:** Drag the group from the Node Editor into the opened Bin window. A dialog will appear to name the group setting file and the location where it should be saved on disk. The .setting file will be saved in the specified location and placed in the bins for easy access in the future.

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Macros

Some effects aren't built with one tool, but with an entire series of operations, sometimes in complex branches with interconnected parameter controls. Fusion provides many individual effects nodes for you to work with but gives users the ability to repackage them in different combinations as self-contained "bundles" that are either macros or groups. These "bundles" have several advantages:

- They reduce visual clutter in your node tree.
- They ensure proper user interaction by allowing you to restrict which controls from each node of the macro are available to the user.
- They improve productivity by allowing artists to quickly leverage solutions to common compositing challenges and creative adjustments that have already been built and saved.

Macros and groups are functionally similar, but they differ slightly in how they're created and presented to the user. Groups can be thought of as a quick way of organizing a composition by reducing the visual complexity of a node tree. Macros, on the other hand, take longer to create because of how customizable they are, but they're easier to reuse in other comps.

Creating Macros

While macros let you save complex functions for future use in very customized ways, they're actually pretty easy to create.

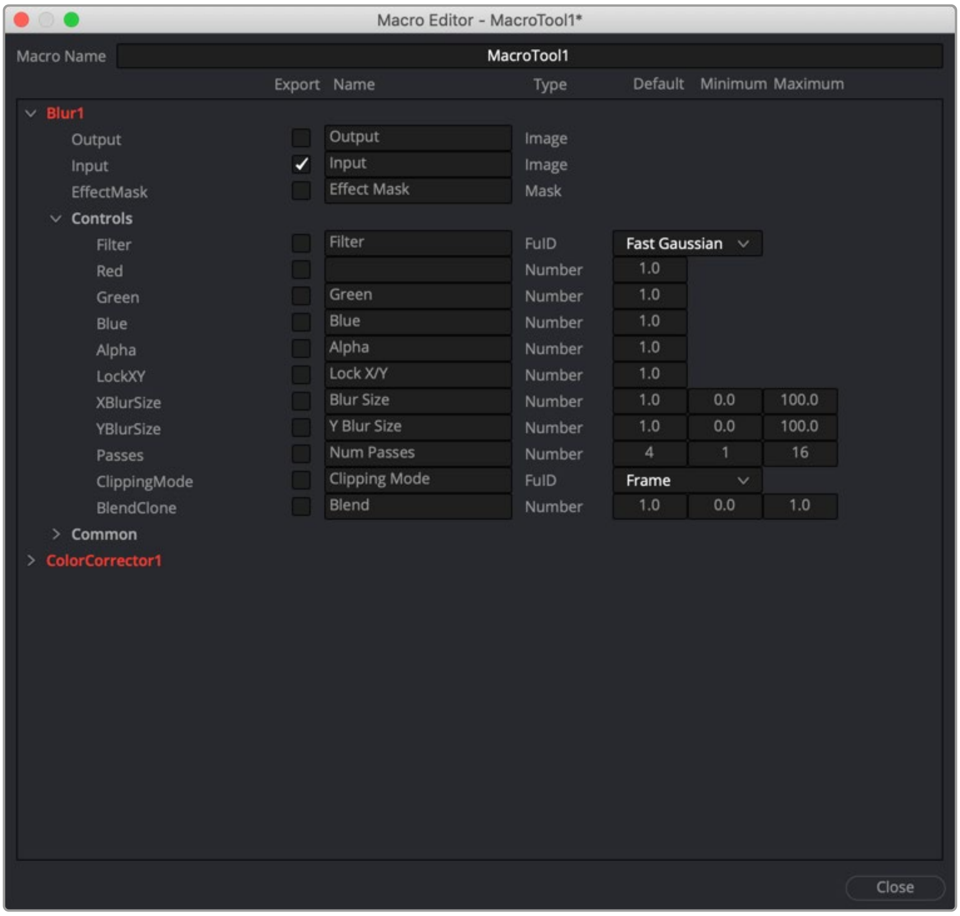
To make a macro from nodes in the Node Editor:

1 Select the nodes you want to include in the macro you're creating. Because the macro you're creating will be for a specific purpose, the nodes you select should be connected together to produce a particular output from a specific set of inputs.

> **TIP:** If you want to control the order in which each node's controls will appear in the macro you're creating, Command-click each node in the order in which you want it to appear.

2 Right-click one of the selected nodes and choose Macro > Create Macro from the contextual menu.

A Macro Editor window appears, showing each node you selected as a list, in the order in which each node was selected.



The macro editor with a Blur node and Color Corrector node.

3 First, enter a name for the macro in the field at the top of the Macro Editor. This name should be short but descriptive of the macro's purpose. No spaces are allowed, and you should avoid special characters.

4 Next, open the disclosure control to the left of each node that has controls you want to expose to the user and click the checkbox to the right of each node output, node input, and node control that you want to expose.

   The controls you check will be exposed to users in the order in which they appear in this list, so you can see how controlling the order in which you select nodes in Step 1, before you start editing your macro, is useful. Additionally, the inputs and outputs that were connected in your node tree are already checked, so if you like these becoming the inputs and outputs of the macro you're creating, that part is done for you.

   For each control's checkbox that you turn on, a series of fields to the left of that control's row lets you edit the default value of that control as well as the minimum and maximum values that control will initially allow.

5 When you're finished choosing controls, click Close.

6 A dialog prompts you to save the macro. Click Yes.

7 A Save Macro As dialog appears in which you can re-edit the Macro Name (if necessary), and choose a location for your macro.

   To have a macro appear in the Fusion page Effects Library Tools > Macros category, save it in the following locations:

   - **On macOS:** Macintosh HD/Users/username/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Fusion/Macros/
   - **On Windows:** C:\Users\username\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\DaVinci Resolve\Support\Fusion\Macros
   - **On Linux:** home/username/.local/share/DaVinciResolve/Fusion/Macros

   To have a macro appear in the Fusion Studio Effects Library Tools > Macros category, save it in the following locations:

   - **On macOS:** Macintosh HD/Users/username/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/Fusion/Macros/
   - **On Windows:** C:\Users\username\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\Fusion\Macros
   - **On Linux:** home/username/.fusion/BlackmagicDesign/Fusion/Macros

8 When you're done, click Save.

Using Macros

Macros can be added to a node tree using the Add Tool > Macros or Replace Tool > Macros submenus of the Node Editor contextual menu.

Re-Editing Macros

To re-edit an existing macro, just right-click anywhere within the Node Editor and choose the macro you want to edit from the Macro submenu of the same contextual menu. The Macro Editor appears, and you can make your changes and save the result.

Groups Can Be Accessed Like Macros

Groups can also be loaded from the Insert Tool > Macros submenu if you save a group's setting file to the Macros folder in your file system. For example, on macOS, the Macintosh HD/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Fusion/Macros/ directory.

Other Macro Examples

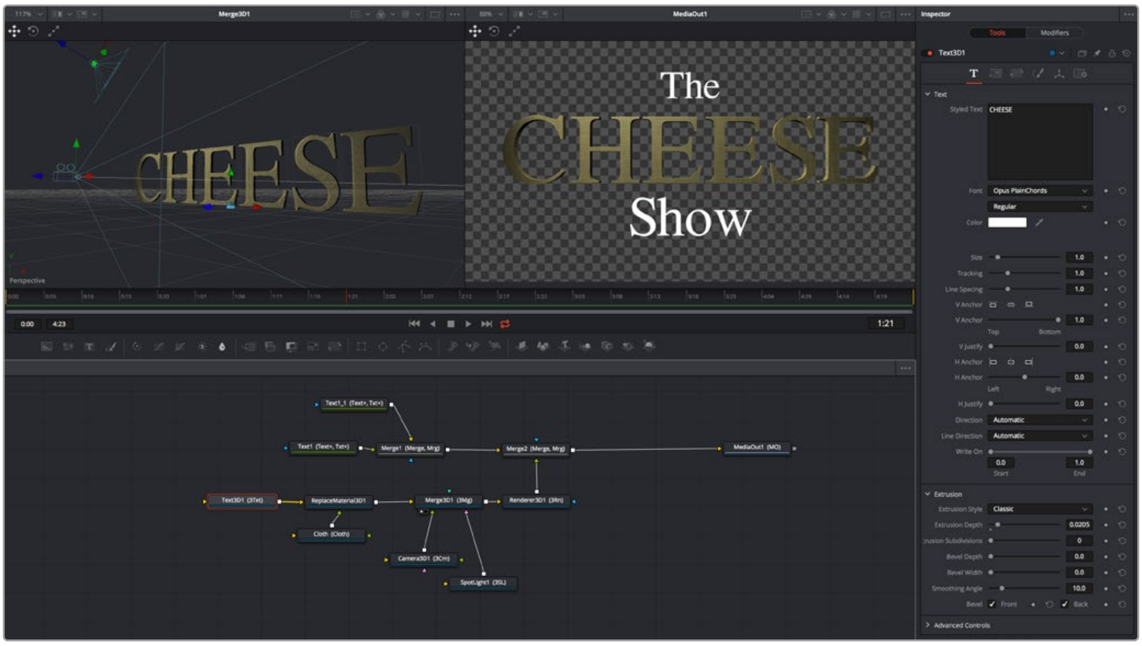
A macro can also be used as a custom LUT. Just copy the macro's .setting file to the LUTs: folder, and the macro will be selectable in the viewers as a LUT. These LUT macros can be used for more than just a color adjustment; you could make a macro that does YUV 4:2:2 resampling, a resize, a sharpening filter, or just watermarking.

Creating Fusion Templates

The integration of Fusion into DaVinci Resolve has enabled the ability to create Fusion Titles, Transitions, Effects, and Generators templates for use in the Edit page. You can create these templates in the Fusion page or within Fusion Studio and then copy them into DaVinci Resolve. Fusion Titles, Generators, and Transition templates are essentially comps created in Fusion but editable in the Timeline of the Edit page with custom controls. This section shows you how it's done.

Getting Started with a Fusion Title Template

The first part of creating a Fusion title template is to create a Fusion composition consisting of Fusion-generated objects assembled to create nearly any kind of title or generator you can imagine. If you're really ambitious, it can include animation. In this example, 3D titles and 2D titles have been combined into a show opener.



Building a composition to turn into a title template.

Saving a Title Macro

Macros are basically Fusion compositions that have been turned into self-contained nodes. Ordinarily, these nodes are used as building blocks inside of Fusion so that you can turn frequently-made compositing tricks that you use all the time into your own nodes. However, you can also use this macro functionality to build title templates for the Edit page.

Having built your composition, select every single node you want to include in that template except for the MediaIn and MediaOut nodes in DaVinci Resolve or Loader and Saver nodes in Fusion Studio.

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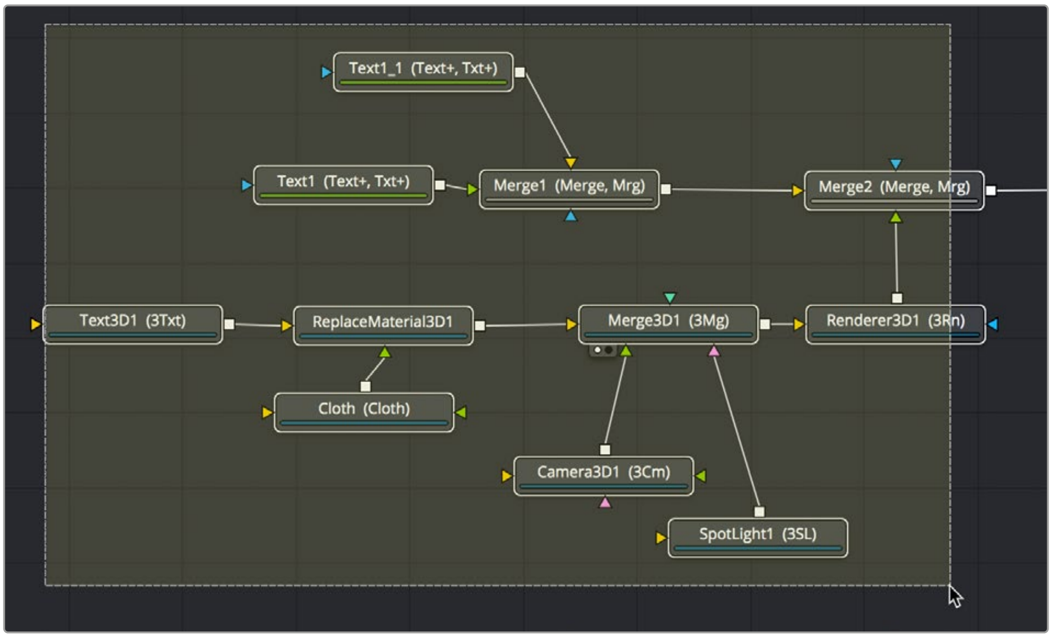
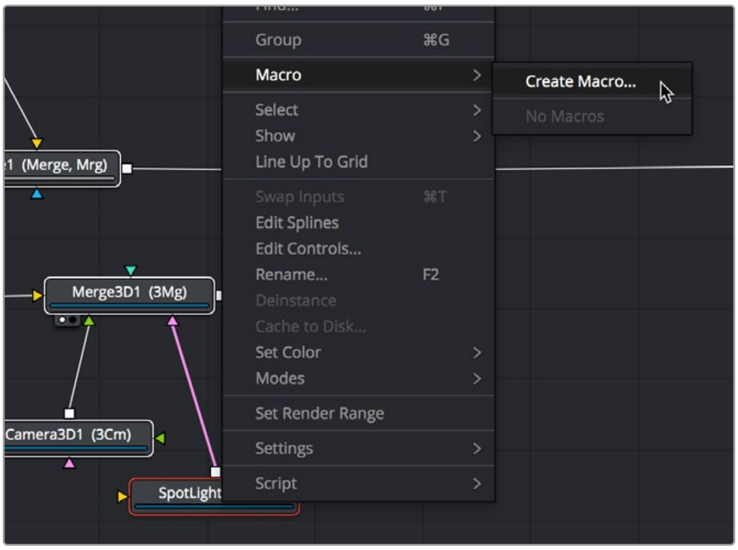


Selecting the nodes you want to turn into a title template.

TIP: If you want to control the order in which node controls will be displayed later on, you can Command-click each node you want to include in the macro, one by one, in the order in which you want controls from those nodes to appear. This is an extra step, but it keeps things better organized later on.

Having made this selection, right-click one of the selected nodes and choose Macro > Create Macro from the contextual menu.



Creating a macro from the selected nodes.

The Macro Editor window appears, filled to the brim with a hierarchical list of every parameter in the composition you've just selected.

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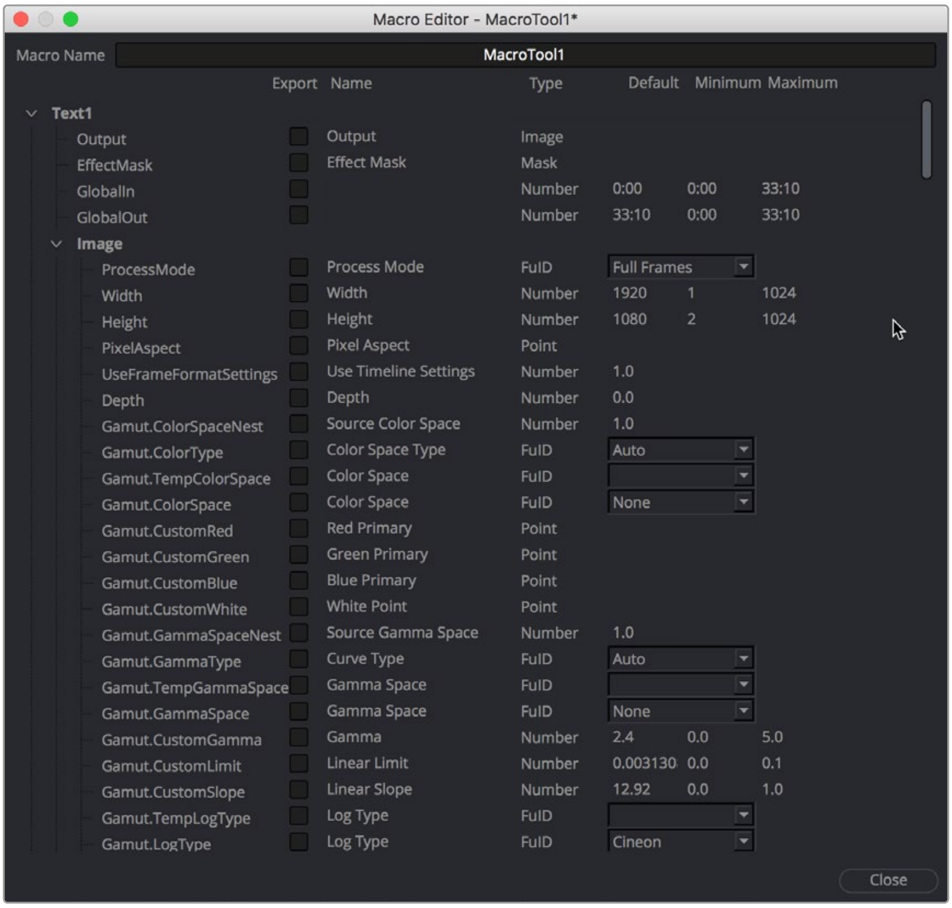
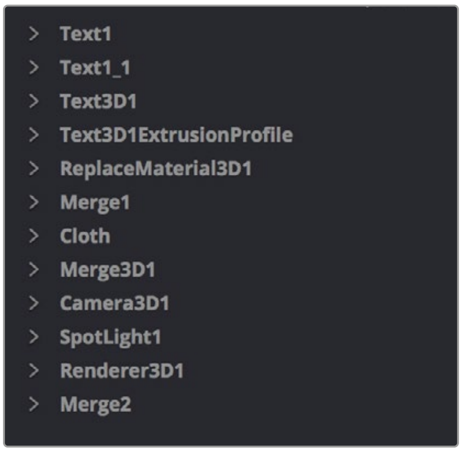


The Macro Editor populated with the parameters of all the nodes you selected.

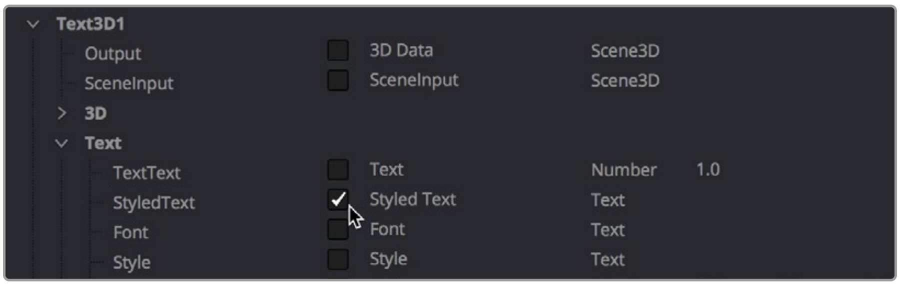
This list may look intimidating, but closing the disclosure control of the top Text1 node shows us what's really going on.



A simple list of all the nodes we've selected.

Closing the top node's parameters reveals a simple list of all the nodes we've selected. The Macro Editor is designed to let you choose which parameters you want to expose as custom editable controls for that macro. Whichever controls you choose will appear in the Inspector whenever you select that macro, or the node or clip that macro will become.

So all we have to do now is to turn on the checkboxes of all the parameters we'd like to be able to customize. For this example, we'll check the Text3D node's Styled Text checkbox, the Cloth node's Diffuse Color, Green, and Blue checkboxes, and the SpotLight node's Z Rotation checkbox, so that only the middle word of the template is editable, but we can also change its color and tilt its lighting (making a "swing-on" effect possible).



Selecting the checkboxes of parameters we'd like to edit when using this as a template.

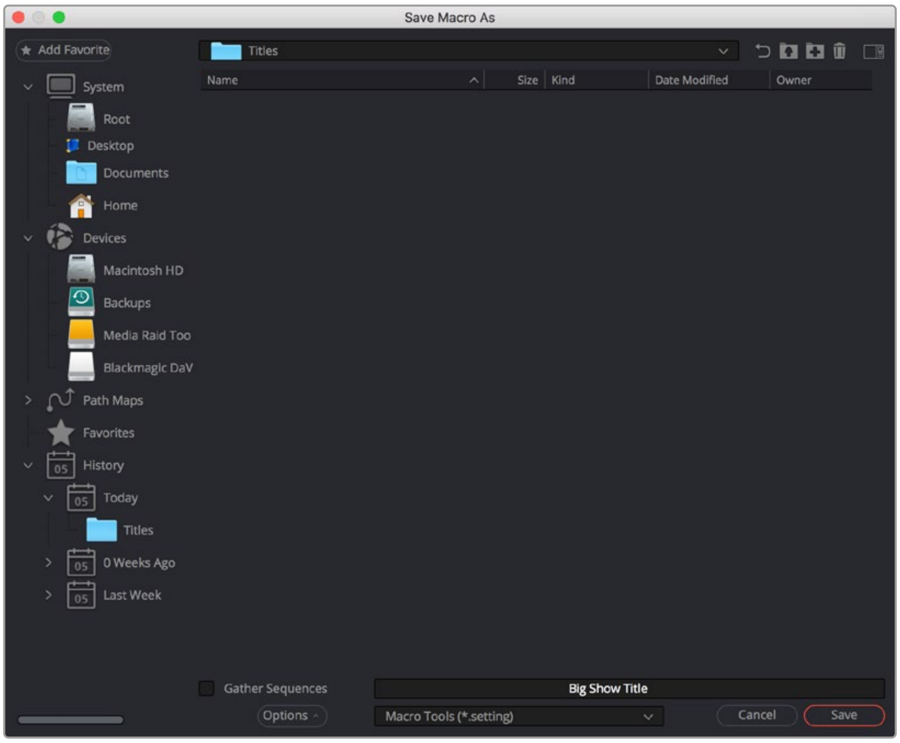
Once we've turned on all the parameters we'd like to use in the eventual template, we click the Close button, and a Save Macro As dialog appears.

To have the Title template appear in the Effects Library > Titles category of DaVinci Resolve, save the macro in the following locations:

On macOS: Macintosh HD/Users/username/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Titles

On Windows: C:\Users\username\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\DaVinci Resolve\Support\Fusion\Templates\Edit\Titles

On Linux: home/username/.local/share/DaVinciResolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Titles



Choosing where to save a title template for the Edit page in DaVinci Resolve.

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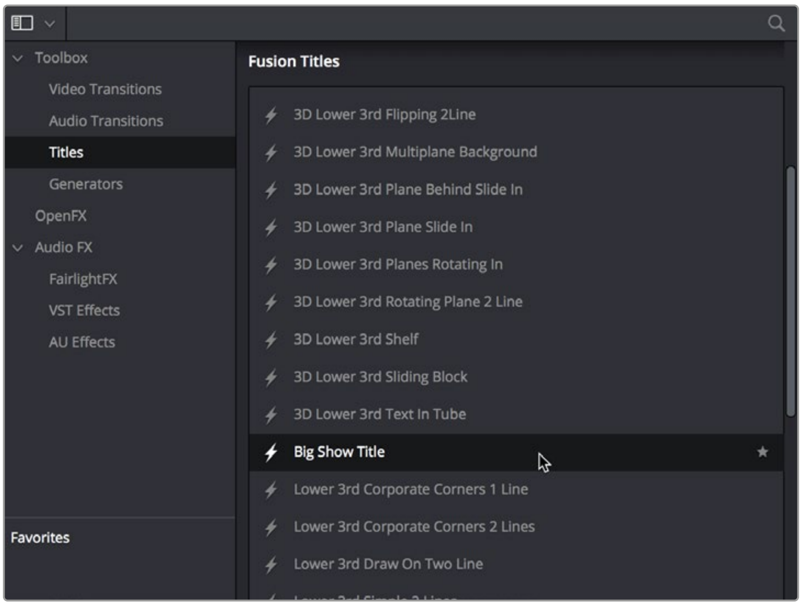
Using Your New Title Template

After you've saved your macro, you'll need to quit and reopen DaVinci Resolve. When you open the Effects Library of the Edit page, you should see your new template inside the Titles category, ready to go in the Fusion Titles list.



Custom titles appear in the Fusion Titles section of the Effects Library.

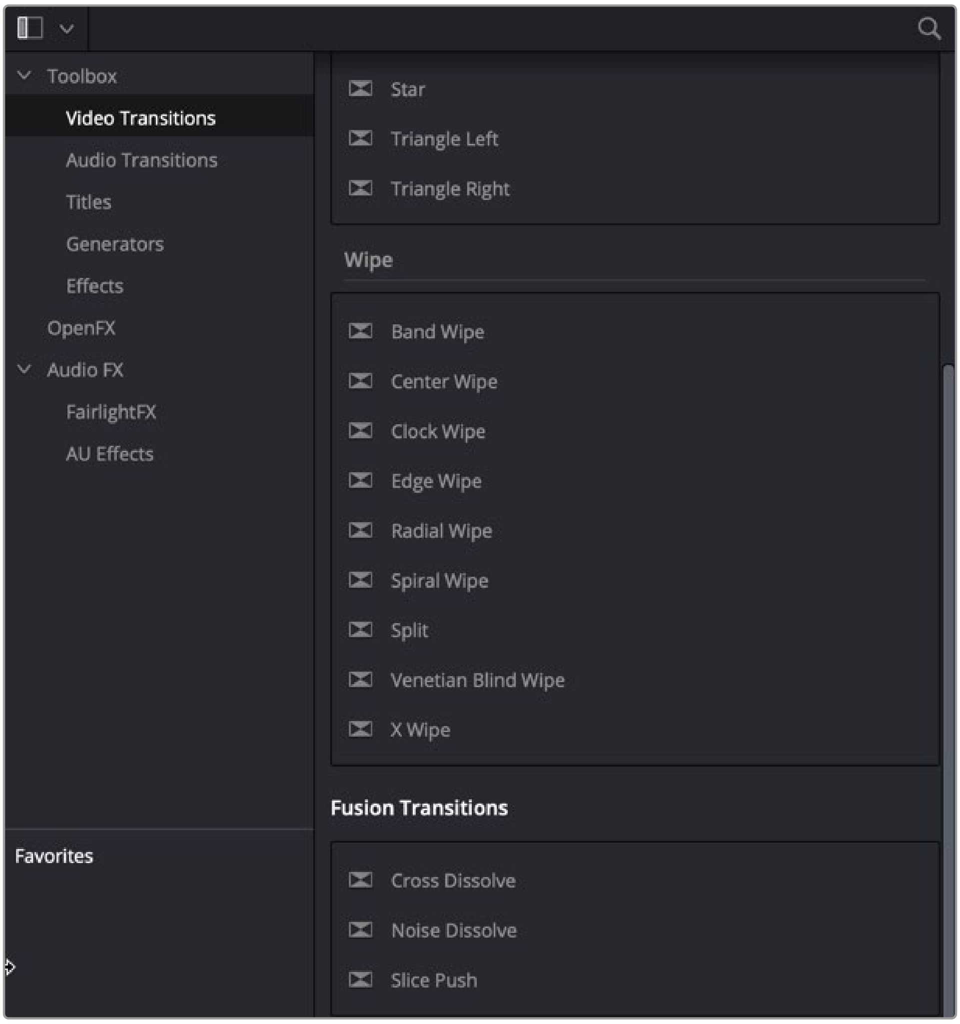
Editing this template into the Timeline and opening the Inspector, we can see the parameters we enabled for editing, and we can use these to customize the template for our own purposes.

Customizing the template we made.

And that's it!

Getting Started with a Fusion Transition Template

When creating a Fusion transition template, it's easiest to start with an existing transition template and build off that. Three transitions are located in the Fusion Transitions category of the DaVinci Resolve Effects Library. The simplest transition is the Cross Dissolve, while the most complex example is the Slice Push.



The Fusion transition templates located in DaVinci Resolve's Effects Library.

Creating a Fusion Transition Template

The three Fusion Transitions located in the DaVinci Resolve Effects Library are basically Fusion compositions that have been turned into macros. Ordinarily, macros are used as building blocks inside of Fusion so that you can turn frequently-made compositing tricks that you use all the time into your own nodes. However, you can also use this macro functionality to build transition templates for the DaVinci Resolve Edit page.

Once you apply a Fusion Transition in the Edit page, you can right-click it and choose Open in Fusion Page.

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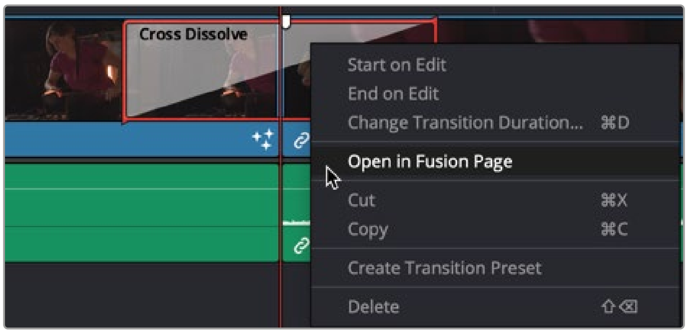
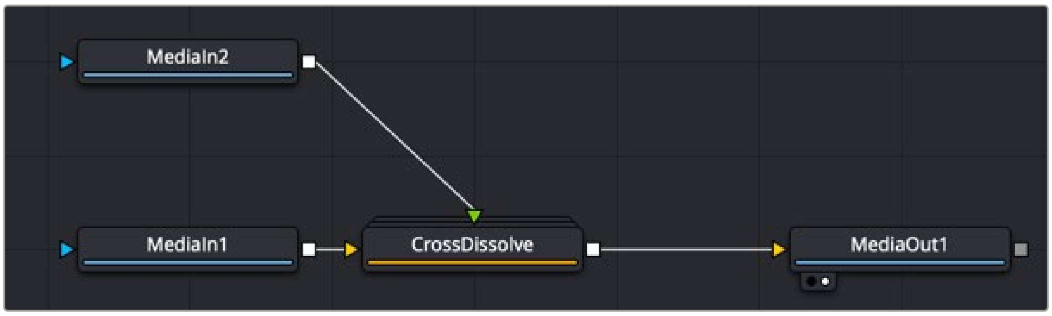


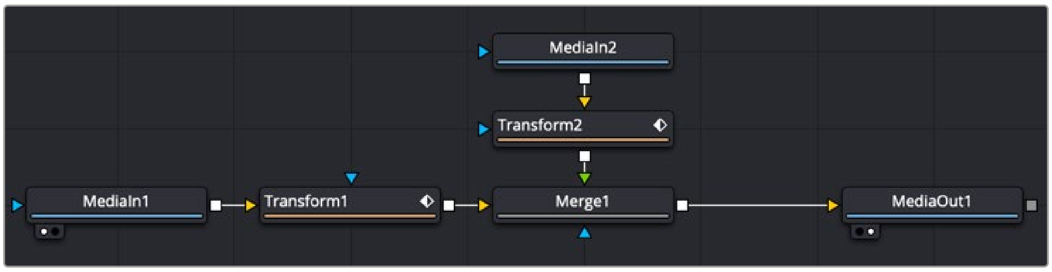
Right-clicking over a Fusion Transition in the DaVinci Resolve Edit page.

The Fusion page opens, displaying the node tree used to create the Fusion transition.



The Cross Dissolve node tree in Fusion.

The MediaIn 1 node represents the outgoing clip in the Edit page Timeline. The MediaIn 2 clip represents the incoming clip. You can modify or completely change the Cross Dissolve effect to create your own custom transition using any of Fusion's nodes.



The Fusion Cross Dissolve node tree replaced with Transforms and a Merge node.

TIP: To modify the duration of the Fusion transition from the Edit page Timeline, you must apply the Resolve Parameter Modifier to any animated parameter. In place of keyframing the transition, you create the transition using the Scale and Offset parameters of the Resolve parameter modifier.

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Updating a Fusion Transition

After modifying the transition in Fusion, you can choose to update the transition in the Timeline or create a new transition, which you save into the Edit page Effects Library. To update the transition, just return to the Edit page. The transition in the Edit page Timeline reflects the changes you make in the Fusion page.

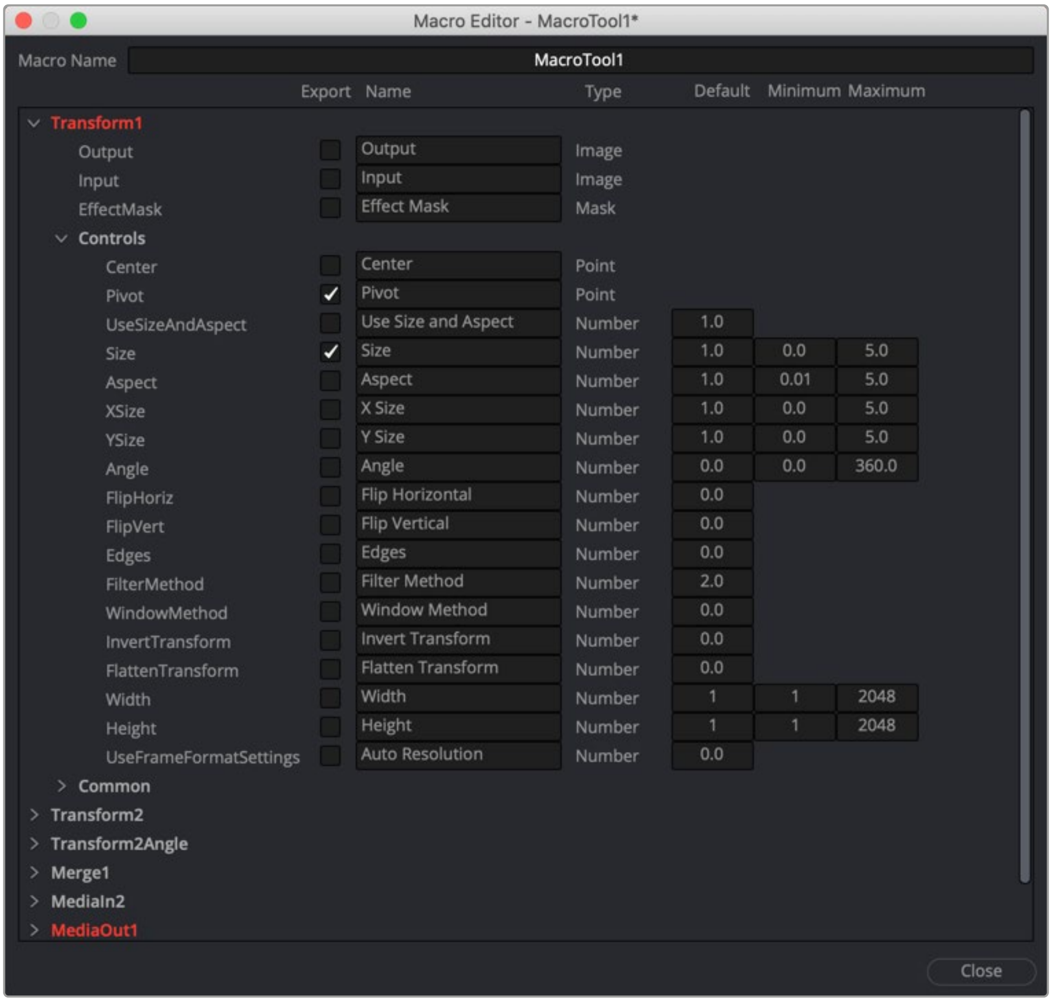
Saving a New Fusion Transition

If after modifying the transition in Fusion, you need to save it to the Effects Library to reuse it on other transitions or other projects, you must make a macro and save it to the Transitions folder.

Start by selecting every node in the Node Editor that you want to include in the transition template, including the two MediaIn nodes and the MediaOut node.

> **TIP:** Since the transition template must include the MediaIn and MediaOut nodes, the final steps for saving a transition template must be performed in DaVinci Resolve's Fusion page and cannot be performed in Fusion Studio.

Having made this selection, right-click one of the selected nodes and choose Macro > Create Macro from the contextual menu.



The Macro Editor displaying the parameters of all the nodes you selected.

The Macro Editor window appears, displaying a hierarchical list of every parameter in the composition you've just selected. The order of nodes is based on the order they were selected in the Node Editor prior to creating the macro.

The Macro Editor is designed to let you choose which parameters you want to display as custom controls in the Edit page Inspector when the transition is applied.

For transitions, you can choose not to display any controls in the Inspector, allowing only duration adjustments in the Timeline. However, you can choose a simplified set of parameters for customization by enabling the checkboxes next to any parameter name.

Once you enable all the parameters you want to use in the eventual template, click the Close button, and a Save Macro As dialog appears. Here, you can enter the name of the transition, as it should appear in the Edit page Effects Library.

To have the transition template appear in the Effects Library > Fusion Transitions category of DaVinci Resolve, save the macro in the following locations:

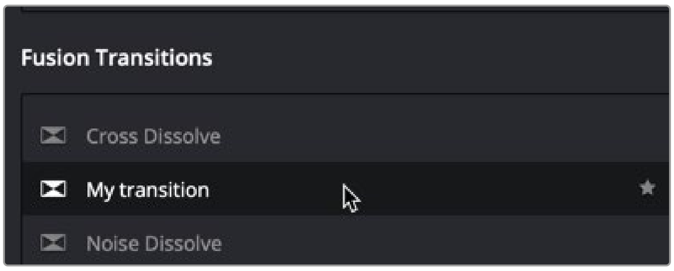
On macOS: Macintosh HD/Users/username/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Transitions

On Windows: C:\Users\username\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\DaVinci Resolve\Support\Fusion\Templates\Edit\Transitions

On Linux: home/username/.local/share/DaVinciResolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Transitions

Using Your New Transition Template

After you've saved your macro, you'll need to quit and reopen DaVinci Resolve. When you open the Effects Library on the Edit page, the new transition template is listed in the Video Transitions category, in the Fusion Transitions list.



A custom Fusion Transition saved in the Edit page Effects Library.

Applying this transition to a cut in the Timeline and opening the Inspector shows the parameters you enabled for editing, if any.

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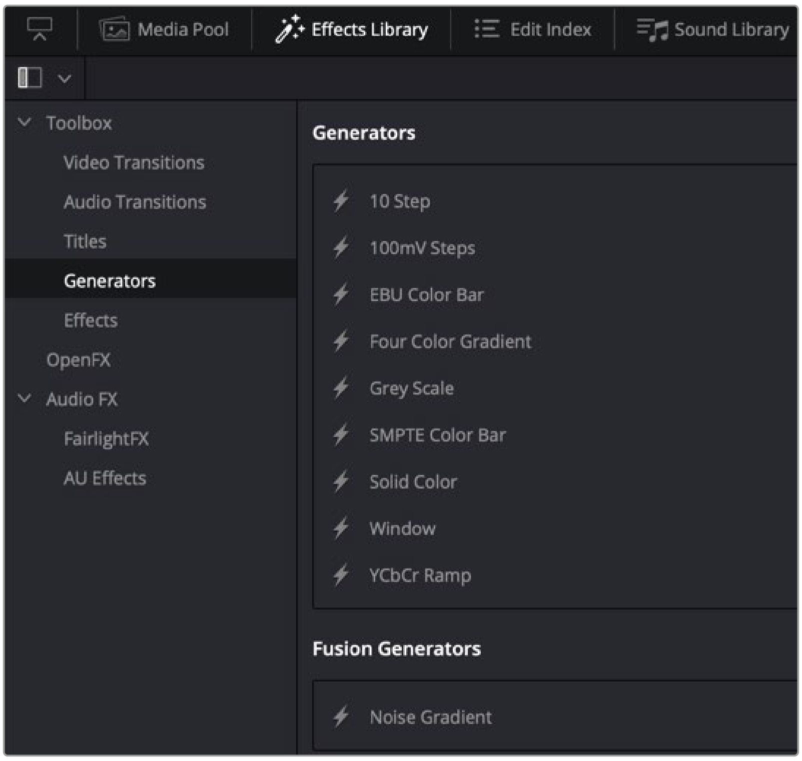
Getting Started with a Fusion Generator Template

There is one simple Noise Gradient Fusion Generator located in the Effects Library that you can use as a starting point for creating your own generators.



The Fusion Generator templates located in DaVinci Resolve's Effects Library.

To open the Fusion Noise Gradient Generator in the Fusion page, do the following:

1 On the Edit page, drag the Fusion Noise Gradient Generator from the Effects Library to the Timeline.
2 Right-click over the Noise Gradient Generator and choose Open in Fusion Page from the pop-up menu.

The Fusion page opens, displaying the node tree that is used to create the Fusion Generator.

Creating a Fusion Generator Template

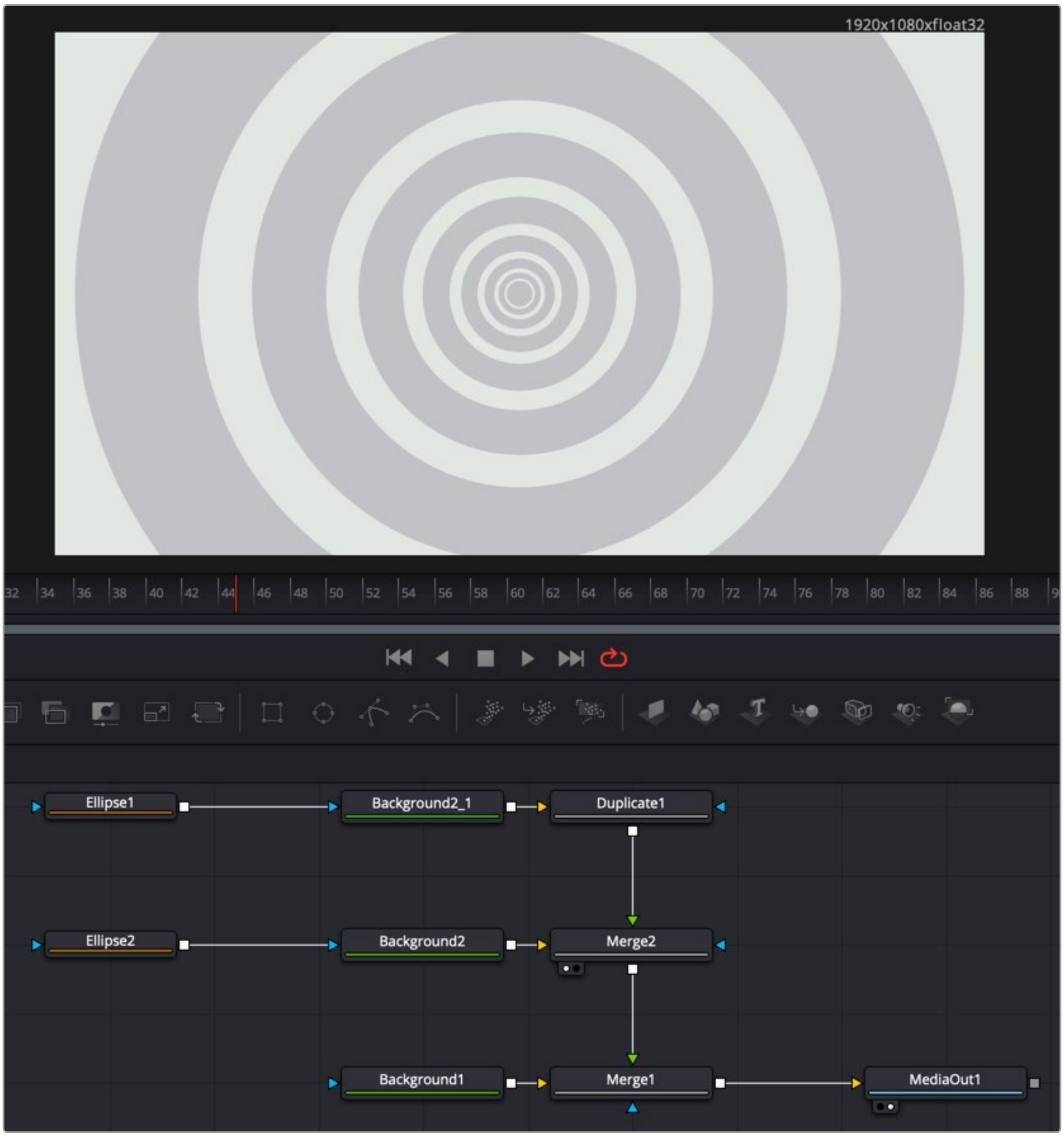
As easy as it is to begin with the Noise Gradient Generator template, you can just as easily start by adding a Fusion Composition Effect to a Timeline in the Edit page.

To begin creating a Fusion Generator Template with an empty Fusion composition, do the following:

1 On the Edit page, drag the Fusion Composition Effect from the Effects Library to the Timeline.
2 Right-click over the Composition Effect and choose Open in Fusion Page from the pop-up menu.

An empty Fusion page with a single MediaOut node opens, ready for you to create a Fusion Generator.

The Fusion Generator is a solid image generated from any number of tools combined to create a static or animated background. You can choose to combine gradient colors, masks, paint strokes, or particles in 2D or 3D to create the background generator you want.



The Fusion Generator node tree creating concentric circles.

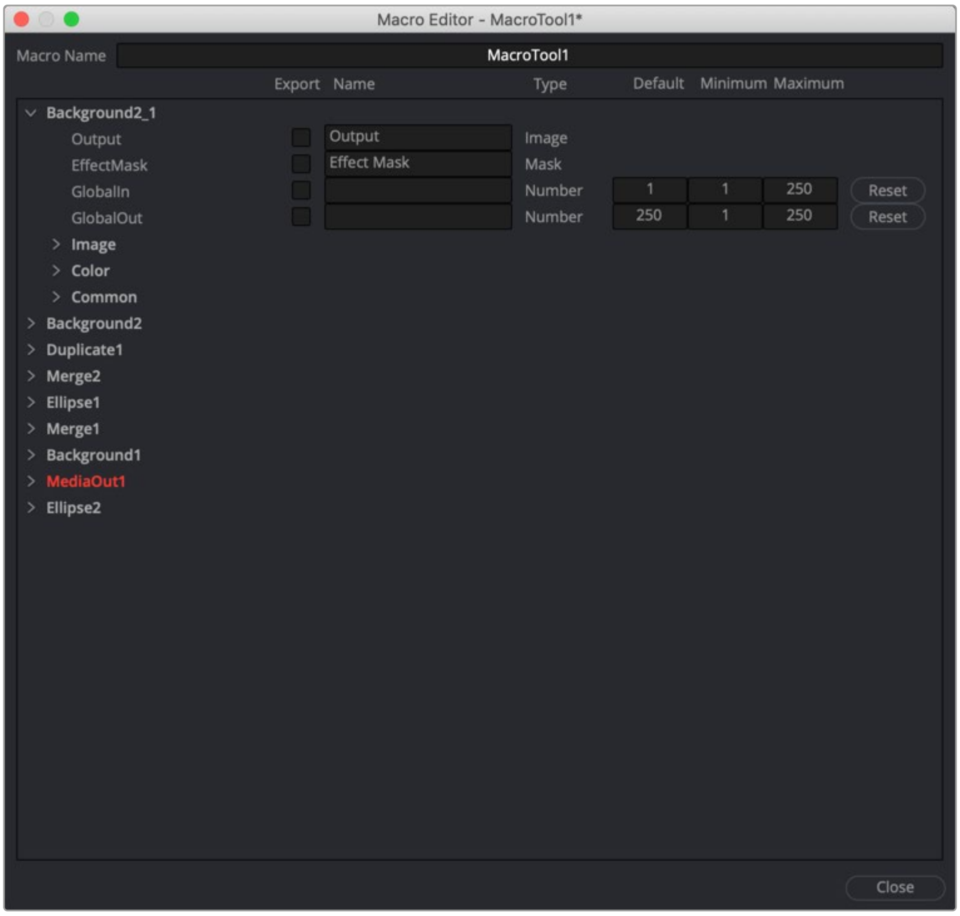
Saving a New Fusion Generator

After creating the generator you want in Fusion, you need to save it to the Effects Library to reuse it in other projects from the Edit page. To do this, you must create a Macro and save it to the Generator folder.

Ordinarily, macros are used as building blocks inside of Fusion so that you can turn frequently-made compositing tricks that you use all the time into your own nodes. However, you also use this macro functionality to build Generator templates for the DaVinci Resolve Edit page.

Start by selecting every node in the Node Editor that you want to include in the Generator template including the MediaOut node.

Having made this selection, right-click one of the selected nodes and choose Macro > Create Macro from the contextual menu.



The Macro Editor displaying the parameters of all the nodes you selected.

The Macro Editor window appears, displaying a hierarchical list of every parameter in the composition you've just selected. The order of nodes is based on the order they were selected in the Node Editor prior to creating the macro.

The Macro Editor is designed to let you choose which parameters you want to display as custom controls in the Edit page Inspector when the Generator is applied. You can choose a simplified set of parameters for customization by enabling the checkboxes next to any parameter name.

Once you enable all the parameters you want to use in the eventual template, click the Close button, and a Save Macro As dialog appears. Here, you can enter the name of the Transition, as it should appear in the Edit page Effects Library.

To have the Generator template appear in the Effects Library > Fusion Generators category of DaVinci Resolve, save the macro in the following locations:

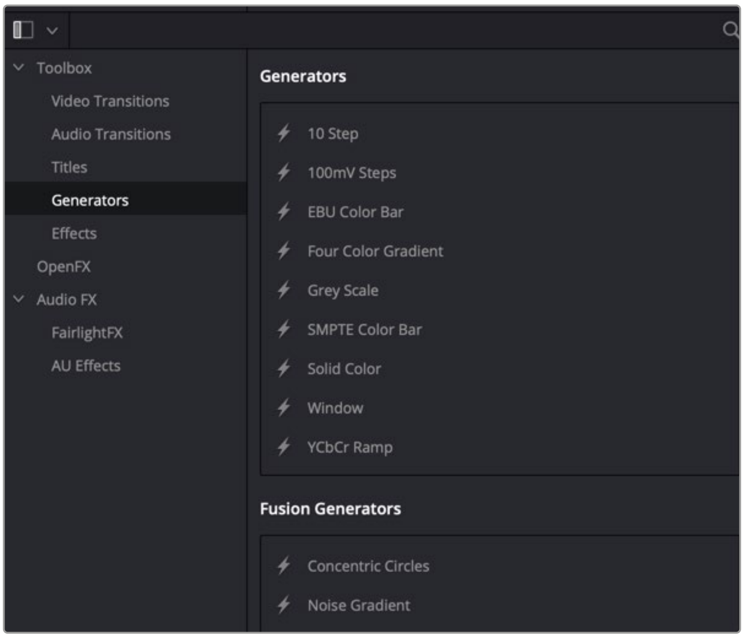
On macOS: Macintosh HD/Users/username/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Generators

On Windows: C:\Users\username\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\DaVinci Resolve\Support\Fusion\Templates\Edit\Generators

On Linux: home/username/.local/share/DaVinciResolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Generators

Using Your New Generator Template

After you've saved your macro, you'll need to quit and reopen DaVinci Resolve. When you open the Effects Library on the Edit page, the new Generator template is listed in the Generators category, in the Fusion Generators list.



Custom Fusion Generator saved in the Edit page Effects Library.

Applying this Generator to the Timeline and opening the Inspector shows the parameters you enabled for editing, if any.

Creating a Fusion Effect Template

You start building a Fusion Effect template by bringing a clip from the Edit page Timeline into Fusion. This clip is only used for creating the template and will not be saved with the effect.

Once inside Fusion, you use Fusion's nodes to create the effect you want. You can use a single node or a hundred, depending on the effect you want to create. For instance, using Fusion's Color Correction nodes, you can create a simple color corrector you can use on the Edit page.

To create a simple Color Corrector effect, do the following:

1 Insert the Color Corrector node between the MediaIn and MediaOut nodes.

2 Select the Color Corrector node in the Node Editor, and then press Cmd-A to select the remaining nodes.

3 Right-click over any of the selected node and choose Macro > Create Macros from the contextual menu. Enabling the checkboxes in this window determines the parameters that appear in the Edit page Inspector.

4 The Macro Editor window opens. Here, you can enable the checkboxes for any parameters you want to be shown in the Edit page Inspector.

5 Enter the name of your effect at the top of the Macro Editor window.

6 To save the Macro, click Close at the bottom of the window, then click Yes in the dialog that appears asking you to save the changes.

The Macros must be saved into the correct folder for DaVinci Resolve to recognize the Macro as an effect.

In the save dialog, save the Macro in the following locations:

On macOS: Macintosh HD/Users/username/Library/Application Support/Blackmagic Design/DaVinci Resolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Effects

On Windows: C:\Users\username\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\DaVinci Resolve\Support\Fusion\Templates\Edit\Effects

On Linux: home/username/.local/share/DaVinciResolve/Fusion/Templates/Edit/Effects

You can save and organize your Fusion Effects into separate subfolders underneath the paths above. These subfolders will show up in the Effects section in the Edit page.

To see the effect in the Edit page Effects Library, you'll need to quit DaVinci Resolve and relaunch the application.

Creating a Fusion Effect Template for Two or More Layers

If the effect you want to create requires multiple images like a video wall, you start by creating a Fusion clip on the Edit page Timeline that includes the number of layers you want the effect to have. The clips are only used to create the number of image inputs for the template and will not be saved with the effect.

Once inside Fusion, use Fusion's nodes to create the effect you want.

Save the Macro following the same steps you use for single clip effects. Enable any of the parameters you want to control in the Edit page. To be able to switch the order of video layers within the effect, make sure you have the Layer checkbox enabled for all the MediaIn nodes.

Once you've saved the Macro and relaunched DaVinci Resolve, to use the effect on multiple timeline layers, you must create a Fusion clip. The Fusion clip should contain the same number of layers the effect requires. The order of the Timeline layers, going from the bottom track to the top, matches the MediaIn numbers. For instance, video track 1 will match the position and appearance of MediaIn1, video track 2 matches MediaIn2 and so on. If you want to change how tracks map to MediaIn nodes, you can change the Layer number in the Inspector, assuming you enabled the MediaIn Layer checkbox when creating the Macro.

Changing Durations of a Template

After you make a template in Fusion, you may want to change its duration in the Edit or Cut page Timeline. Changing the duration when animation is involved can be complicated, so there are two Modifiers in Fusion that can help determine how keyframes react when the duration is updated in the Edit or Cut page Timeline.

Anim Curves Modifier

The Animation Curves Modifier (Anim Curves) is used to dynamically adjust the timing, values, and acceleration of an animation, even if you decide to change the duration of a Comp. Using this Modifier, it becomes infinitely easier to stretch or squish animations, create smooth motion, add bouncing properties, or mirror animations curves without the complexity of manually adjusting splines.

When creating Fusion templates for the Edit or Cut page in DaVinci Resolve, the Anim Curves Modifier allows the keyframed animation you've created in Fusion to stretch and squish appropriately as the transition, title, or effect's duration changes on the Edit and Cut page Timelines.

Keyframe Stretcher Modifier

The Keyframe Stretcher modifier is primarily used when creating title templates in Fusion for use in DaVinci Resolve's Edit or Cut page. The Keyframe Stretcher modifier is added to any animated parameter so that the Hold keyframes between the initial animation on screen and the final animation off-screen stretch when the template is trimmed in the Timeline. This allows the animation to retain its timing while the static portion of the title stretches to meet the new duration requirements.

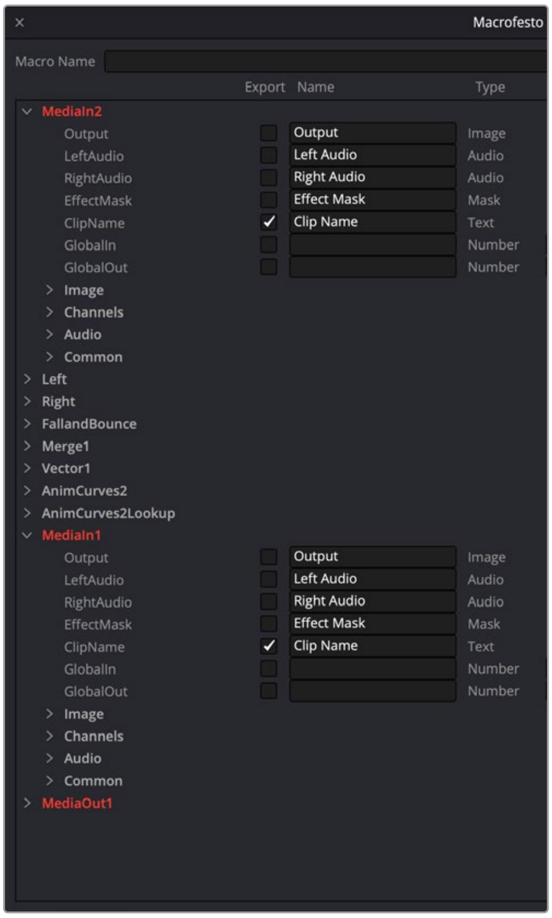
Creating Media Drop Zones in Templates

For additional ease of use in the Edit page, Fusion effects, plugins, and transitions can have media drop zones, allowing the user to simply drag clips from the Media Pool directly to the template. For example, you can instantly replace the background of a Fusion effect with a star-field, just by dragging that clip from the Media Pool to the media drop zone in the Inspector.

To create a media drop zone in a Fusion template:

1. Create a Macro of your current Fusion template.
2. For any MediaIn node that you want to make a media drop zone, make sure the ClipName parameter is checked.
3. Place your template in the appropriate Fusion Edit template folder (Transition, Effect, etc.), and relaunch DaVinci Resolve.

   When you use this template in the Edit page, now you can drag clips from the Edit page Media Pool and drop them in the Transition Inspector's Clip Name field. They will then instantly update the template with the chosen media.



The Clip Name parameters are checked for MediaIn2 and MediaIn1 nodes in the Macro Editor, allowing media drop zones for both incoming and outgoing sides of this Fusion transition.

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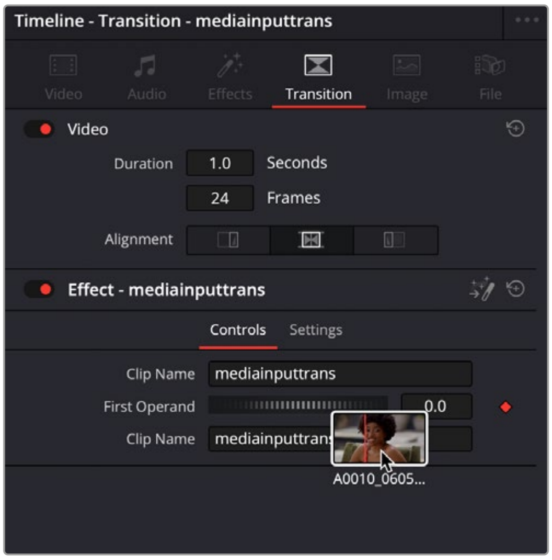

A clip from the Media Pool being dropped on a Clip Name field in the resulting Transition Inspector in the Edit page

Creating a Custom Template Icon

It is possible to create a custom icon that is embedded with your template thumbnail in the Effects Library, instead of the default first three letters of the template name.

To create a simple Custom Template Icon:

1. Create a .png file of the icon you want to use for the template. The recommended size is 104 x 58 pixels, but any image will be resized to fit.
2. Name the file exactly the same name as your template, just with a .png extension rather than a .setting extension.
3. Place the .png image in the same directory as your template.

When you restart DaVinci Resolve, the icon you created will be embedded in the template thumbnail across all the Effects Libraries in the program.

A Custom Icon added to a fisheye template, before (above) and after (below)

Using Fusion Template Bundles

For ease in distributing templates to other Fusion users, multiple templates can now be bundled together into a single .drfx file. This file can then be imported back into another Fusion workstation easily to ensure that all custom templates are the same between computers.

Creating a Fusion Template Bundle requires using a specific directory structure and using your operating systems file browser and .zip compression utility. The directory structure is listed below, and you can always find a specific folder from within Fusion by right-clicking on any bin in the Effect Library and selecting Show Folder.

Folder structure for Templates used in the Edit page:

- Edit
- Effects
- Generators
- Titles
- Transitions

Folder structure for Templates used in the Fusion page:

- Fusion

To create a Fusion Template Bundle:

1. In your OS, create a folder structure above that includes the specific folder for the type of templates you want to be in the bundle. For example, if you have a transition and two effects templates, you would create an Edit folder, and two subfolders inside it named Transitions and Effects.
2. Copy your template (.setting) files into the appropriate directories. You can also include icon files and any associated assets as well.
3. Use your OS zip compression utility to create a .zip file of the directory structure.
4. Rename the .zip file in your OS with the ".drfx" extension instead of .zip. The file icon should change to reflect the new extension.

To import a Fusion Template Bundle:

1. Double-click on a .drfx file in your OS. DaVinci Resolve will launch and a dialogue box will appear asking if you want to install the template bundle.
2. Drag to the .drfx file from your OS directly into the Fusion page in DaVinci Resolve. A dialogue box will appear asking if you want to install the template bundle.

To delete a Fusion Template Bundle:

1. Navigate to the appropriate template directory in your file browser.
2. Delete the .drfx file.

IMPORTANT: The Fusion Template Bundle contains all the templates in one file. It does not uncompress them into separate template files again. Therefore if you delete the .drfx file, all associated templates inside that bundle will be removed as well.